finalization of the framework agreement on SAPTA. The Summit also endorsed an Integrated Programme of Action (IPA) on eradication of poverty in South Asia, trade manufacture and services, environment pollution, population growth, shelter for the homeless child labour, youth unrest and unemployment, disabled persons, women's development, science and technology, terrorism, drug trafficking, security of small states, people-to-people contact, and other.

## Eighth Summit: New Delhi, 2–4 May 1995

In the Eighth Summit held in New Delhi, the Heads of States and Governments expressed their satisfaction on the achievements of the First Decade of SAARC and resolved to celebrate the completion of the First Decade by the individual member states and collectively. They endorsed the proposal of the Council of Ministers to convene a Commemorative Session of the Council on the theme "SAARC-Vision for the Second Decade". In addition, they also agreed to operationalize the South Asian Free Trade Area (SAFTA) and its establishment to promote intra-regional trade. Further, they welcomed the establishment of WTO and expressed the hope that it would help to expand international trade particularly that of the developing countries.

## Ninth Summit: Male, 12–14 May 1997

In the Ninth Summit hed in Male, the Heads of States and Governments welcomed the entry into force of the Agreement on SAPTA on 7 December 1995. They also recognized the importance of achieving a free trade area by the year 2001. Moreover, they also vowed to fight poverty, combat terrorism and drug trafficking, and create awareness and cooperation in such areas as women's development, child labour, youth unrest and unemployment, disabled persons, shelter for the homeless, increasing literacy, and environment pollution and management.

## Tenth Summit: Colombo, 29–31 July 1998

In the tenth Summit held in Colombo, the Heads of States and Governments reaffirmed their faith in the commitment to the objectives and principles of SAARC and called for enhancing political